Ishkhan Khchoian

IT Project Manager — Agile / Scrum delivery

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English (C1) · Russian (native) · Armenian (native)

PROFILE

IT project manager with over six years of running projects across different business areas. Trained in project management to U.S. standards in a U.S. Embassy program in Yerevan, where we ran a training IT project end to end — a mobile banking app, including Scrum; PSM I exam scheduled for November 2026. I run delivery in Jira and Confluence.

Today I am COO of SayWhen.am, an AI voice-agent startup: I run development with the CTO from specification and backlog to acceptance and lead the company's corporate clients through every stage of cooperation. Before that I redesigned client-project processes in U.S. companies and delivered construction projects on fixed deadlines — results below.

WHY ME FOR THIS ROLE

- **Delivery against fixed deadlines.** In a family construction business I ran projects including an investment project of 11 state and private tenders worth RUB 42M — from interiors, facades and roofing to special-purpose telecom facilities. Every object was delivered on time with no remarks.
- **Process redesign with measurable results.** As a case manager in U.S. legal companies I rebuilt client-project workflows. In one company the cycle became strictly six months or less, express tracks of two and four months appeared, errors dropped, and the share of successful cases rose by 35%.
- **I write the process, not just follow it.** My templates, checklists and hand-off rules became the team standard; the internal training program I built went on to serve 50+ people.
- **Enough technical footing to be useful.** SDLC, REST APIs, JSON, Postman and Swagger/OpenAPI specs; a C programming intensive at 42 Yerevan; I build working prototypes with AI coding tools.

SKILLS

- **Delivery:** Scrum · Kanban · Waterfall · sprint planning, refinement, reviews and retros · user stories and acceptance criteria · MoSCoW and RICE prioritization · milestones, Gantt and critical path · risk register and change control · RACI · status reporting (velocity, burndown, plan vs. actual)
- **Technical:** software development lifecycle · API contracts (REST, JSON, OpenAPI) · Postman · dev / staging / production release flow · CI/CD basics · non-functional and security requirements
- **Tools:** Jira · Confluence · Miro · Notion · Trello · Monday · Bitrix24 · amoCRM · Google Workspace · MS Office · Claude Code

EXPERIENCE

COO — SayWhen.am (AI voice-agent startup)

Feb 2026 – present

- Run product development with the CTO in Jira and Confluence: requirements, specification, backlog and priorities, acceptance of each stage.
- Lead the company's corporate clients through every stage of cooperation; wrote the specification for a retrieval-based (RAG) assistant for an insurance company.

Freelance — project and legal work

Feb 2026 – present

- Designed a U.S. client-acquisition pilot for **Karas Systems** (B2B go-to-market consultancy): funnel model in three scenarios, budget, payback and decision gates.
- Business research for a water production line; CPA/affiliate manager (under NDA); legal projects — IP assignment for works of popular musicians, corporate structure for a crypto trader; sale of family real estate.

Senior Case Manager — M&M Document Preparation (U.S.) Jun 2025 – Feb 2026

- Owned up to **12 complex client projects in parallel** end to end against immovable external deadlines.
- Redesigned the delivery process: cycle **strictly ≤ 6 months**, new **express tracks of 2 and 4 months**, fewer errors thanks to a shared knowledge base, **successful cases +35%**.
- Coordinated **8 specialists** against written acceptance criteria; my templates, checklists and hand-offs became the team standard.

Event / Project Manager — Hosq Corp. Jan 2025 – Jun 2025

- Delivered live events for **100 to 3,000** people — several in parallel, on dates that could not slip; owned vendors, logistics, scheduling and day-of operations.

Project Manager — Qanon Construction Aug 2024 – Dec 2024

- Client communication, scope agreement, timelines and internal follow-through.

Legal practice — U.S. legal companies, Arbitration Court, Bar Association Dec 2019 – Aug 2024

- Senior Paralegal at Shamayev Business Law, Paralegal at Bloomrich Law Firm: built the internal training program **Paralegal Academy** (50+ people) and worked on the firms' processes.
- Judge's Associate: **200+ parallel cases, 30+ hearings a week**; earlier, contract analysis and claims at a Bar Association.

Project Manager — LLC "SIS" (family construction & retail business) Jun 2015 – Sep 2019

- Ran projects including an **investment project of 11 state and private tenders worth RUB 42M** — all objects delivered **on time with no remarks**.
- Teams of up to 20; procurement, logistics between sites, recruiting; built the first schedules and Gantt charts; set up the retail supply network across the region.

EDUCATION & TRAINING

- **Project management, U.S. perspective** — "Project Management with a U.S. Perspective: Skills for Global Success" — Yerevan American Corner, a joint program of the U.S. Embassy Yerevan and the City Central Isahakyan Library; Jul 21 – Aug 21, 2026, in person, Certificate of Achievement; training IT project end to end: a mobile banking app, including Scrum.
- **Professional Scrum Master I (Scrum.org)** — exam scheduled for November 2026.
- **Project Management** — PM Club, 2023 (52 hours).
- **Piscine intensive (C programming)** — 42 Yerevan, Nov–Dec 2025; passed selection and completed it alongside a full-time job.
- **Bachelor of Law, with honors** — North-Eastern State University, 2021; Civil Law, Faculty of Law — St. Petersburg State University, 2016.

ALSO

- **2nd place, HackNation** local pitches, final at TUMO Labs (July 2026); **Startup Seaside Summit** — participant.
- **Highload++** (700 attendees) — organizing team, led a crew of 12; performance bonus.
- **Ethos Foundation** — HQ coordinator, Sep 2023 – Oct 2024; aid to ~100 families a day.